

Spring-MVC @ModelAttribute Annotation

<http://www.baeldung.com/spring-mvc-and-the-modelattribute-annotation>

1. At Method Level

```
@ModelAttribute
public void addAttributes(Model model) {
    model.addAttribute("msg", "Welcome to the Netherlands!");
}
```

Spring-MVC will always make a call first to that method, before it calls any request handler methods. **That is, @ModelAttribute methods are invoked before the controller methods annotated with @RequestMapping are invoked.** The logic behind the sequence is that, the model object has to be created before any processing starts inside the controller methods.

It is also important that you annotate the respective class as [@ControllerAdvice](#). Thus, you can add values in *Model* which will be identified as global. This actually means that for every request a default value exists, for every method in the response part.

The *@ControllerAdvice* assists a controller and in particular, *@ModelAttribute* methods that apply to all *@RequestMapping* methods.

If a method annotated with *@ModelAttribute* is not in *@ControllerAdvice* controller, that method is called for requests only for the containing controller.

2. As a Method Argument

```
@RequestMapping(value = "/addEmployee", method = RequestMethod.POST)
public String submit(@ModelAttribute("employee") Employee employee) {
    // Code that uses the employee object

    return "employeeView";
}
```

When used as a method argument, it indicates the argument should be retrieved from the model. When not present, it should be first instantiated and then added to the model and once present in the model, the arguments fields should be populated from all request parameters that have matching names.